

another job soon. But in today's economy, most people don't get rehired immediately; it could take months or even years.

If you or your spouse loses a job, you must *immediately* go back to your 90-Day Number. Redo the worksheet in [chapter 6](#), this time cutting one-third of your expenses. Involve your kids in the discussion. Do it as a family, because you will all need to make adjustments in the way you live. Betty's not going to summer camp. You won't be buying a car and you won't be going on vacation. Drop your magazine subscriptions and cut your fitness center membership. You'll be running on the open road.

**Money Mistake:** *You Got a New Job! Time to Spend!*

**The Fix:** *Learn the Lesson: Savings First*

Four months after getting laid off, Mom gets a new job at the same level. The family starts spending like crazy. "Great!" they say. "We can get back to our old lifestyle."

Not so fast. It's time to get the whole family around the dinner table once again. You should be using *all* of Mom's new income to reduce debt and to save in case this happens again one day.

The good news is you understand that jobs are tenuous, and no matter how good you are at what you do, you could lose a whole career in a split second. So you'll make adequate preparations this time, shoring up your family dynasty. You'll pay off your debt and start saving everything you can in your Secret 10 in case a layoff strikes again in the future.

**Money Mistake:** *Thinking About the Expense of Death Feels Wrong*

**The Fix:** *Face the Funeral Music*

Death is sad. No news there. It's not great for our finances, either, bringing with it unexpected costs and hidden fees. Everybody is going to deal with death—and there's a whole industry that profits from it.